

DAILY FINANCIAL BULLETIN

Global Macro & Crypto Market Intelligence

Wed, Sep 23 2026

RISK-ON Low VIX, strong crypto ETF inflows and broad risk appetite support the market's RISK_ON regime.

Markets are maintaining a **RISK_ON** profile: the VIX fell 4.64% to **14.18**, while the copper/gold ratio rose 6.87%. Despite a 0.42% rise in the DXY to 100.85, technology shares remained strong, with NVIDIA up 2.30%, Meta 11.43% and Tesla 3.03%. Total crypto market capitalization stood at **\$2.93 trillion**, although it declined 2.70% over 24 hours; BTC gained 13.42% over seven days, while ETH and several altcoins outperformed. The Fear & Greed Index was 71, classified as Greed, and BTC dominance stood at 58.68%. Spot Bitcoin ETFs recorded \$714.7 million of inflows on September 22, including \$350.3 million for IBIT and \$257.4 million for FBTC; however, positive funding alongside a negative Coinbase premium and a -3.34% 25Δ risk reversal shows that leveraged longs still seek downside protection. No CPI, PPI, PCE or FOMC decision is scheduled in the provided calendar; the next FOMC meeting is on October 28, with the median rate projection at 4.1%.

STRATEGIC RESEARCH FOCUS

COMMODITIES

As Hormuz traffic weakens, why is the market not pricing a lasting oil shock?

Shipping traffic through the Strait of Hormuz remains below its 10-day average while European equities rise as oil falls, creating a gap between physical-flow risk and market pricing. The key research question is whether weaker traffic signals a durable supply disruption and how much of that risk oil prices already discount; track traffic normalization, inventories, and weekly supply data.

PRIMARY SOURCES / REPORTS:

- **Reuters** — **Shipping traffic via Strait of Hormuz stays below 10-day average, data shows - reuters.com** — Examine current vessel traffic through Hormuz and its deviation from the 10-day average.
- **EIA** — **Weekly Petroleum Status Report** — Check U.S. crude and product inventories, refinery utilization, and supply-flow confirmation.

MACRO

Can the hawkish Fed narrative simultaneously reverse the dollar, gold, and European risk backdrop?

Hawkish Fed commentary has strengthened rate-hike bets as the DXY rose to 100.85, gold retreated, and European equities benefited from weaker oil. The research question is whether this reflects a durable real-rate/dollar regime or short-term positioning; monitor Fed pricing, Treasury yields, dollar direction, and whether upcoming jobless claims deviate from the 201K forecast.

PRIMARY SOURCES / REPORTS:

- **Reuters — Gold retreats as hawkish Fed comments reinforce policy tightening bets - reuters.com** — Examine how hawkish Fed commentary is transmitting into gold and rate-hike expectations.
- **CME FedWatch Tool** — Track probabilities for the next meeting and intraday changes in hawkish pricing.
- **US Treasury — Daily Yield Curve Rates** — Check short- and long-maturity Treasury yields and the curve's response to Fed expectations.

CRYPTO

Why do strong ETF inflows conflict with defensive positioning in Bitcoin derivatives?

Bitcoin ETFs attracted \$714.7 million and Ethereum ETFs \$162.2 million on September 22, yet total crypto market capitalization fell 2.70% over 24 hours; Bitcoin funding was positive, open interest rose 1.98%, and the Coinbase premium stood at -0.0109. The research question is whether ETF demand represents genuine spot accumulation or is being offset by leverage and distribution; monitor Bitcoin's 80,443.945 support and 86,609.37 resistance, continued ETF flows, and a move in the Coinbase premium from negative to positive.

PRIMARY SOURCES / REPORTS:

- **Farside — Bitcoin ETF Flows (All Data)** — Examine whether the \$714.7 million September 22 inflow is sustained by fund and subsequent daily flows.
- **Farside — Ethereum ETF Flows** — Check the product-level distribution and continuation of the \$162.2 million Ethereum ETF inflow.
- **Coinglass — Derivatives Data** — Use funding rates, open-interest changes, and liquidation data to test the leverage impact behind ETF inflows.

NASDAQ 100 31,023 ▼ -0.02%	DXY 100.8510 ▲ +0.42%	GOLD \$4,353 ▼ -0.53%	10Y UST N/A —	VIX 14.2 ▼ -4.64%	BTC \$85,831 ▼ -0.27%	BTC.D 58.7% —	F&G INDEX 71 Greed
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TODAY'S CALENDAR

NEXT FOMC
Wed (35 days away)

MEDIAN DOT (2026)
4.10%

DATE	TIME (TRT)	EVENT	COUNTRY	PREV	CONS	ACTUAL
23 Sep Wed	10:15	● French Flash Manufacturing PMI	EUR	51.5	50.9	N/A

DATE	TIME (TRT)	EVENT	COUNTRY	PREV	CONS	ACTUAL
23 Sep Wed	10:15	• French Flash Services PMI	EUR	48.4	48.3	N/A
23 Sep Wed	10:30	• German Flash Manufacturing PMI	EUR	54.1	54.1	N/A
23 Sep Wed	10:30	• German Flash Services PMI	EUR	48.5	49.9	N/A
24 Sep Thu	15:30	• Unemployment Claims	USD	196K	201K	
25 Sep Fri	17:00	• Revised UoM Consumer Sentiment	USD	47.8	47.4	
25 Sep Fri	17:00	• Revised UoM Inflation Expectations	USD	4.6%	N/A	

EQUITIES & COMMODITIES

ASSET	PRICE	24H	7D	30D	TREND
• AAPL Apple	338.98	▲ +0.85%	▲ +1.77%	▲ +8.89%	
• MSFT Microsoft	501.61	▲ +1.59%	▼ -0.75%	▲ +4.25%	
• GOOGL Alphabet (Google)	354.97	▲ +1.55%	▲ +1.60%	▲ +4.26%	
• AMZN Amazon	258.45	▲ +1.87%	▲ +1.94%	▼ -0.64%	
• NVDA NVIDIA	227.38	▲ +2.30%	▲ +7.78%	▲ +4.97%	
• META Meta	741.25	▲ +11.43%	▲ +11.45%	▲ +35.91%	
• TSLA Tesla	375.30	▲ +3.03%	▲ +4.55%	▲ +8.74%	

ASSET	PRICE	24H	7D	30D	TREND
• XAU Gold	\$4,353.20	▼ -0.53%	▼ -0.78%	▼ -7.34%	
• XAG Silver	\$65.81	▼ -0.19%	▲ +2.36%	▼ -3.99%	
• HG Copper	\$6.82	▲ +0.89%	▲ +6.03%	▲ +3.34%	
• BZ Brent Oil	\$95.46	▼ -3.82%	▼ -9.80%	▲ +3.57%	

S&P 500 SECTORS

TECHNOLOGY XLK N/A	FINANCIALS XLF N/A	HEALTH CARE XLV N/A	CONSUMER DISCRET. XLY N/A	COMMUNICATION XLC N/A	INDUSTRIALS XLI N/A
CONSUMER STAPLES XLP N/A	ENERGY XLE N/A	UTILITIES XLU N/A	REAL ESTATE XLRE N/A	MATERIALS XLB N/A	

LIQUIDITY

FED BALANCE SHEET

\$6.75T

▲ +0.09% w/w

STABLECOIN SUPPLY

\$258.5B

▲ +0.21% 24H

CRYPTO DESK

TOTAL MARKET CAP

\$2.93T

▼ -2.70%

BTC DOMINANCE

58.7%

24H TOTAL VOLUME

\$119.9B

TOTAL3 (EX BTC & ETH)

\$0.88T

Analyst Note: Total stablecoin market capitalization rose 0.21% to \$258.55 billion, supporting the view that fresh liquidity is entering the market. The 2Y-10Y spread and SMH data are unavailable, so the yield curve and semiconductor breadth cannot provide additional confirmation.

DERIVATIVES DESK

\$85,831 ▼ -0.27%

Support Level

\$80,444

Resistance Level

\$86,609

Price at \$85,831 is holding above **support** (\$80,444), with **resistance** at \$86,609.

COINBASE PREMIUM INDEX — 7D

BTC/USD · Coinbase vs Global Spread (1H Bars)

-0.0109%

▼ US selling pressure

+0.022%

24h High

-0.020%

24h Low

+0.115%

-0.115%

11:00

20:00

05:00

15:00

00:00

10:00

Reading Guide: Positive values indicate US institutional buying pressure. Sustained positive premium is a bullish signal for BTC.

FEAR & GREED



FUTURES TERM STRUCTURE & POSITIONING

NEUTRAL

BTC BASIS ETH BASIS

BTC and ETH funding rates were positive at 0.0144% and 0.0113%, respectively, indicating long-oriented positioning. Futures basis data is unavailable, so the size of the premium cannot be confirmed; positive funding can increase vulnerability to excessive leverage.

BTC MAX PAIN (QUARTERLY)

\$76,000

DERIBIT DVOL INDEX

37.84 ▲ +0.33

OPTIONS PUT/CALL RATIO

0.57

FUNDING RATES (8H EQ.)

BTC	▲ +0.0144%
ETH	▲ +0.0113%
SOL	N/A

OPEN INTEREST (OI)

BTC	196.49M ▲ +1.98%
ETH	82.13M ▼ -0.56%
SOL	32.46M ▼ -2.95%

SPOT BITCOIN ETF FLOWS

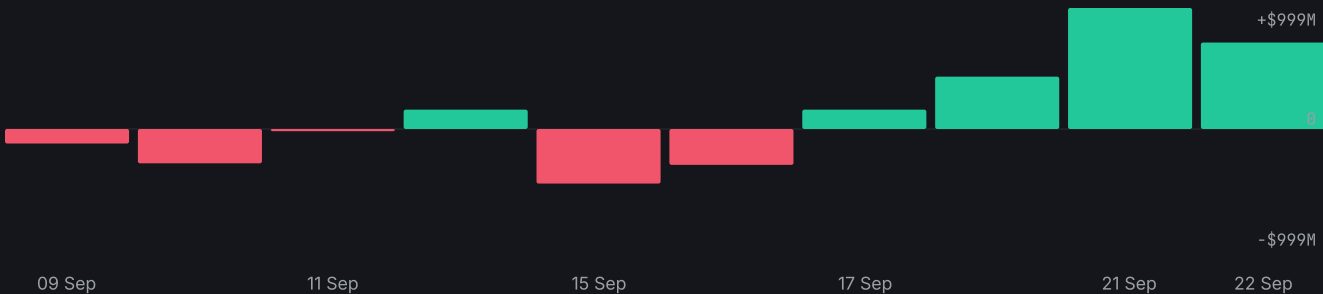
ETF Daily Net Flows

22 Sep 2026

STRONG INFLOW

TOTAL FLOW	IBIT (BLACKROCK)	FBTC (FIDELITY)
+714.7M	+350.3M	+257.4M

SPOT ETF FLOWS HISTORY (LAST 10 DAYS)



Analyst Note: Spot Bitcoin ETFs attracted \$714.7 million in total inflows, signaling direct buying pressure and continued institutional demand; IBIT contributed \$350.3 million and FBTC \$257.4 million. Positive flows indicate demand, while negative flows indicate selling pressure; the recent two-day inflow streak reinforces the risk-on signal.

ETH Spot ETF Daily Net Flows

22 Sep 2026

STRONG INFLOW

TOTAL FLOW

+162.2M

ETHA (BLACKROCK)

+88.1M

FETH (FIDELITY)

+33.6M

CRYPTO WATCHLIST

ASSET	PRICE	1H	24H	7D
• BTC	\$85,831.00	▼ -0.05%	▼ -0.27%	▲ +13.42%
• ETH	\$2,732.87	▲ +0.01%	▼ -0.53%	▲ +13.85%
• XRP	\$1.5900	▼ -0.08%	▲ +3.70%	▲ +24.21%
• SOL	\$117.41	▼ -0.04%	▲ +0.22%	▲ +21.04%
• TRX	\$0.342736	▼ -0.18%	▼ -1.37%	▲ +2.40%
• HYPE	\$95.5800	▲ +0.01%	▲ +0.44%	▲ +23.36%
• DOGE	\$0.099673	▲ +0.19%	▲ +1.35%	▲ +25.67%
• LINK	\$12.8800	▲ +0.21%	▼ -0.61%	▲ +19.98%
• UNI	\$10.1100	▼ -1.06%	▲ +15.21%	▲ +61.60%
• AVAX	\$11.2000	▲ +0.54%	▲ +2.98%	▲ +53.90%

TOP STORIES

CNBC · 09:22

South Korea pushes for Trump summit with renegade North Korea, seeing opportunity for peace



AI Insight: South Korea's push for a Trump-North Korea summit could reduce the geopolitical risk premium; the VIX at 14.18 and strong ETF inflows indicate that markets are preserving risk appetite for now.

REUTERS · 04:53

Gold retreats as hawkish Fed comments reinforce policy tightening bets - reuters.com

AI Insight: Hawkish Fed comments are weighing on gold while the DXY rises 0.42%, suggesting that expectations for rate cuts may be constrained. Still, the 6.87% increase in the copper/gold ratio and positive crypto funding indicate that demand for growth and risk assets has not materially broken down.

REUTERS · 02:46

Rupee edges lower as dollar firms on Fed hike wagers - reuters.com

AI Insight: A stronger dollar driven by Fed rate-hike expectations is pressuring the rupee, highlighting tighter financial conditions for emerging markets. Nevertheless, the low VIX and strong Bitcoin ETF inflows show that global risk appetite has not yet unwound.

NOCASHFLOW bulletin.

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